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members of this group are ensheathed by mucilage cover. They reproduce by vegetative and asexual methods.

Fungi are Eukaryotic, heterotrophic, unicellular or multicellular organisms. The cell wall is made up of chitin. They reproduce asexually by producing sporangiospores, conidia, Thallospores, chlamydospores etc., The sexual reproduction is isogamous, ansiogamous and oogamous. In addition, gametic copulation, gametic fusion, spermatisation are also found. They are beneficial to mankind. Some are known to cause disease in plants and human beings.

Rhizopus is commonly called' Bread mold fungi'. It belongs to the class Zygomycetes. Asexual reproduction occurs by the production of sporangiospores. During sexual reproduction gametangial copulation occurs and zygospore is formed. *Agaricus* belongs to the class Basidiomycetes.It is a saprophytic fungus. Three types of mycelium , primary, secondary and tertiary mycelium are produced. Sexual reproduction is present .Basidiocarps are produced after the sexual reproduction. It bears basidia on which four basidiospores are produced.

The symbiotic association between the roots of higher plants and fungal mycelium is called mycorrhizae. Lichen thallus includes both phycobiont and mycobiont. It is an example for symbiotic association.

Evaluation

1. Which one of the following statement about virus is correct
   a. Possess their own metabolic system
   b. They are facultative parasites
   c. They contain DNA or RNA
   d. Enzymes are present
2. Identify the incorrect statement about the Gram positive bacteria
   a. Teichoic acid absent
   b. High percentage of peptidoglycan is found in cell wall
   c. Cell wall is single layered
   d. Lipopolysaccharide is present in cell wall
3. Identify the Archaebacterium
   a. *Acetobacter*
   b. *Erwinia*
   c. *Treponema*
   d. *Methanobacterium*
4. The correct statement regarding Blue green algae is
   a. lack of motile structures
   b. presence of cellulose in cell wall
   c. absence of mucilage around the thallus
   d. presence of floridean starch
5. Identify the correctly matched pair
   a. Actinomycete – a) Late blight
   b. Mycoplasma – b) lumpy jaw
   c. Bacteria – c) Crown gall
   d. Fungi – d) sandal spike